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1.7 Workaround Inventory

Bots, batch jobs, off-platform documents and manual bridges, each traced to the gap it covers

Deliverable	1.7 Workaround inventory with root cause and to-be disposition
Version	0.6 – items identified from RFP and 1.2 maps; bot specifications, volumes and failure counts from DR-09 [pending W4]; v1.0 at Week 5
Source	RFP (four batch jobs, Blue Prism RPA, surrounding systems); 1.2 maps (off-platform documents, manual hand-offs); DR-09 automation inventory; walk-the-process
Owner	WS4 Technology & Replacement Interface (Platform/Integration Analyst)
Accepted by	Replacement Solution Architect; Head of Technology Operations
Tests	Hypotheses D1 (each bot / batch job covers a missing rule or feature), D2 (off-platform letters mean terms not held on platform), D3 (manual letter issuance has no tracking)

1. Purpose and the rule this document enforces

A workaround is anything that exists because the process or the system could not do what was needed: a bot that re-keys, a batch job that applies a rule the workflow should hold, a letter produced in Word because the platform cannot generate it, a spreadsheet that tracks what the system does not. Workarounds are invisible in process maps and invisible in requirements gathering, because the people who use them no longer see them as workarounds.

The rule: no workaround is carried onto the replacement platform without a recorded decision. Each item below ends in one of four dispositions, and the list of dispositions is deliverable B-08 to the Replacement Programme so that nothing is rebuilt by default.

Disposition	Meaning	Who decides
RETIRE	The gap it covers no longer exists in the to-be process; nothing replaces it	Design Authority
NATIVE	The need is real; the replacement platform meets it as standard configuration (rule, timer, template, integration)	Solution Architect confirms in fit-gap (2.7)
REBUILD	The need is real and the platform cannot meet it natively; a custom component or integration is required	Design Authority; goes on the custom list (O5)
KEEP (interim)	Needed until a later release; retire date set	Replacement Programme

Categories

B Batch jobs · **R** RPA bots · **D** Off-platform documents · **M** Manual bridges between systems or teams · **T** Tracking outside the system · **K** Data-model workarounds.

2. Inventory

ID	Workaround	Cat	L2	What it does (as-is)	Gap it covers	Root cause	Volume / freq.	Risk it carries	Disposition (H)	Evidence needed
W-01	Auto-reoriginate deals at 90 days	B	E2.1 / 2.6	Scheduled job resets deals not progressed within 90 days to origination	Workflow has no timers or expiry on approvals	SYS: no SLA / timer capability in BLP workflow	[DR-09]	Deals reset without RM warning; work lost; MI distortion (restarts counted as new)	NATIVE	Job spec; monthly counts; which deal types; what "re-originate" retains
W-02	Forbearance status update	B	E2.1 / 5.3	Scheduled job sets or clears forbearance status on customer records	Status derived from events the workflow does not act on	SYS: status logic not event-driven	[DR-09]	Lag between event and status; regulatory field (C15) updated outside audit trail of the deal	NATIVE	Job spec; rule it implements; source of trigger data
W-03	Waiver-expired update	B	E2.1 / 5.1	Scheduled job marks covenant waivers expired on date	No native covenant / waiver lifecycle	SYS: no date-driven status in covenant records	[DR-09]	No RM task generated on expiry; breach handling depends on reports	NATIVE	Job spec; counts; whether an RM task follows
W-04	Mass officer-code reassignment	B	E2.1 / E2.3	Bulk reassignment of deals/customers between officer codes (RM moves, SBS take-on)	No ownership-transfer function with audit trail	SYS: ownership is a code field, not a relationship	[DR-09]	Audit trail gap; wrong-owner errors; insider-information exposure if mis-assigned (C27)	NATIVE	Job spec; frequency; who requests; approval
W-05	Blue Prism bot(s) — inventory pending	R	[DR-09]	Each bot: name, trigger, transactions performed	Expected: re-keying between BLP and MEO / IMPACS / TELLER; bulk status updates; report generation	SYS: missing integrations or bulk functions	[DR-09]	Bot failure = silent backlog; brittle to screen change; no business rule documentation	per bot	Bot register with: process automated, volumes, exception rate, maintenance cost, business rule. One row per bot in v1.0

W-06	Facility letter issued manually as PDF by email / post	D / M	3.1	RM downloads FAL from BLP, emails or posts to customer, tracks return by mailbox	No e-delivery, no e-signature, no sent/returned status	SYS: no document delivery or signature capability	c. 25,000 letters / yr	Unreturned letters found at 3-month reset; version control; evidence of issue is an RM mailbox (H-D3)	NATIVE	Walk-the-process confirmation; DR-08 coverage; sample of RM practice by segment
W-07	Off-platform facility letter: Staged Drawdown	D	3.1 / 4.3	RM produces drawdown letter in Word as confirmation of each tranche	Platform cannot generate a tranche-level letter	SYS: template limitation	TBC (allocations)	Terms not held on platform; no C4 reconciliation possible (H-D2)	NATIVE	Sample letters; where stored; who checks
W-08	Off-platform facility letter: Shadow Limit (open question on source)	D	3.1 / 4.3	Possibly RM-produced letter for the shadow limit itself	As W-07	SYS: template limitation	62+ / yr	As W-07	NATIVE	WS-09 to confirm existence
W-09	CAP Strategy memo produced off-platform, attached	D	5.3	SBS writes memo in Word; attaches to deal	No structured strategy record	SYS: no template / structured memo	722 / yr	Strategy content not reportable; version control	NATIVE	Memo template; whether fields are later re-keyed
W-10	Credit analytics performed outside BLP (spreadsheets / external tools) — TBC	D / M	2.1	Debt servicing, classifications, external checks prepared elsewhere, results keyed into BLP	No native analytics or external-check integration	SYS: integration gap	c. 25,900 / yr	Re-keying errors; analysis not evidenced in system (C2)	NATIVE / REBUILD	Walk-the-process; inventory of tools and spreadsheets per segment
W-11	Renewal trigger via BDRM report	T	4.1	Report lists facilities approaching review; RM works from the list	No system task on review date	SYS: no task generation	14,857 / yr	Late starts; missed renewals; no SLA measurement	NATIVE	Report definition; who runs it; frequency
W-12	Hand-off to Fulfilment by message	M	3.4	RM sends message that deal is ready; Fulfilment works from messages	No work queue / task routing to Fulfilment	SYS: workflow ends at “ready”; no cross-team task	c. 25,000 / yr	Queue invisible; no SLA; messages lost	NATIVE	Message channel; Fulfilment’s own tracker (W-15?)
W-13	Instruction to Lending Services for security — channel TBC	M	3.2	RM instructs by email / form	No security task generated from approved deal	SYS: as W-12	TBC	Terms transcribed; instruction lag	NATIVE	WS-12
W-14	Business Lending Form on SharePoint	M	1.1	Customer or RM completes form on SharePoint; RM re-keys into BLP	No digital intake into BLP	SYS: no customer-facing capture	TBC	Re-keying; no lead register (H lead management)	NATIVE / REBUILD	Form fields; volumes; whether customers or RMs complete it

W-15	Team-level trackers (Fulfilment, Lending Services, Credit queue) — TBC	T	2.4, 3.2, 3.4	Spreadsheets tracking work received and completed	No queue visibility in BLP	SYS: no work management	TBC	Duplicate record keeping; divergence from BLP	RETIRE	Walk-the-process in each team
W-16	Deal type “Staged Drawdown” + request type “Variation” to record an allocation	K	1.4 / 4.3	RM combines two fields to express a journey the model lacks	No allocation deal type	SYS / design: deal-type model	TBC	MI misclassification; rule enforcement by convention	RETIRE	DR-01 counts by this combination
W-17	Remove All Facilities recorded as Variation (TBC)	K	4.4	Removal journey recorded under a type that implies continuation	No removal type	design: deal-type model	TBC	Removals not countable; release sequence unmanaged	RETIRE	DR-01; WS-06
W-18	ESR Cleanse as a deal type	K	E2.5	Records migration performed through the deal workflow	No data-migration facility	design: tooling gap	3,816 / yr	Volume distortion; RM effort on non-customer work	RETIRE	SD-01
W-19	Manual delegated-authority determination	M	2.3	RM reads DA matrix and decides routing	No rules engine on limit / exposure / grade	SYS: rule capability	c. 25,900 / yr	Breach risk; inconsistency (C5)	NATIVE	DA matrix (DR-07); data availability check
W-20	Manual shadow-limit reduction on reallocation	M	4.3	RM edits the shadow limit product by hand	No limit arithmetic	SYS	62+ / yr	Double-counted headroom (C19)	NATIVE	Sample check of reallocations
W-21	Balances looked up in MEO / IMPACS	M	1.4	“Provide existing product balances” sourced via other front ends or batch feed — TBC	Integration latency or absence	SYS: integration	all deals	Stale balances in credit submission	NATIVE / REBUILD	Interface inventory from Technology
W-22	Fee processing in TELLER	M	3.4	Fees agreed in BLP keyed into TELLER	No fee integration	SYS: integration	TBC	Fee leakage; re-keying	NATIVE / REBUILD	Interface inventory; fee error MI
W-23	DO NOT USE deal type selectable	K	E2.3	Discontinued type remains in pick list	Reference-data hygiene	admin	—	Mis-keyed deals	RETIRE (now)	I-02 — quick win

Disposition (H): hypothesised pending fit-gap in Phase 2. Volumes marked [DR-09] or TBC are populated in Week 4–5.

3. Root-cause summary

Root cause (SYS unless stated)	Workarounds	Count	Replacement capability that closes it	Fit-gap question for 2.7
No workflow timers, SLAs or date-driven tasks	W-01, W-03, W-11	3	Workflow timers; task generation on dates	Standard in most lending platforms; confirm
No cross-team work management (queues, tasks, hand-offs)	W-12, W-13, W-15	3	Work queues per team; task routing from workflow state	Standard; confirm queue visibility and SLA reporting
No document generation, delivery or e-signature	W-06, W-07, W-08, W-09	4	Template-driven generation from deal data; e-delivery; e-signature; return tracking	Often partner integration (e-signature); custom templates likely
No rules engine on deal data	W-19, W-20, W-02	3	Configurable rules on limit, exposure, grade, status	Standard; depth of rule configuration to confirm
Missing integrations (CIF, MEO/IMPACS balances, TELLER fees, external credit checks)	W-05 (likely), W-10, W-21, W-22, W-14	5	APIs to core, product and bureau systems	Integration is Replacement Programme scope; likely REBUILD items
Deal-type model gaps (design, not system)	W-16, W-17, W-18, W-23	4	Journey patterns with parameters (1.3 §4)	Design decision, not a platform gap
Ownership / reference data without audit trail	W-04	1	Ownership transfer function with audit	Standard; confirm bulk transfer

Twenty-three workarounds trace to seven root causes. Four of the seven are standard capability in modern lending platforms; one (integrations) is Programme scope; two are design choices this project owns. **Hypothesis D1 is supported in structure:** every batch job and manual bridge identified maps to a missing rule, timer, task or integration. Bot-level confirmation (W-05) waits on DR-09.

3.1 Dispositions summary (hypothesised)

Disposition	Items	Count	Implication
RETIRE	W-15, W-16, W-17, W-18, W-23	5	Gap removed by design; no build. W-23 now
NATIVE	W-01, W-02, W-03, W-04, W-06, W-07, W-08, W-09, W-11, W-12, W-13, W-19, W-20	13	Standard configuration if fit-gap confirms; zero custom build
NATIVE / REBUILD (depends on fit-gap)	W-10, W-14, W-21, W-22	4	Integration items; likely on the custom list
Per bot	W-05	?	Each bot dispositioned individually in v1.0

3.2 Quick wins on current BLP (no replacement dependency)

Item	Action	Owner	By	Benefit
W-23	Remove DO NOT USE from pick list	Bank BA / BLP admin	W3	Data quality
W-18	Stop recording ESR Cleanse as deals; route via migration (SD-01)	SteerCo / Programme	G0 → W4	Restated baseline; RM effort released
W-06	Interim: standard email template with tracked send date logged in BLP comments; weekly unreturned-letter report at 6 and 10 weeks	Lending Ops	W8	Fewer 3-month resets before the platform change
W-11	Interim: BDRM report run centrally weekly with RM task list; measure late starts	Lending Ops / MI	W8	Renewal cycle time; baseline for L1

3.3 Open items to v1.0

- DR-09 bot register and batch-job specifications (W4): one row per bot added to §2
- Walk-the-process confirmation of W-10, W-13, W-15, W-21, W-22 (W4–5)
- Interface inventory from Technology for W-21, W-22, W-14
- Deal-type combination counts from DR-01 for W-16, W-17